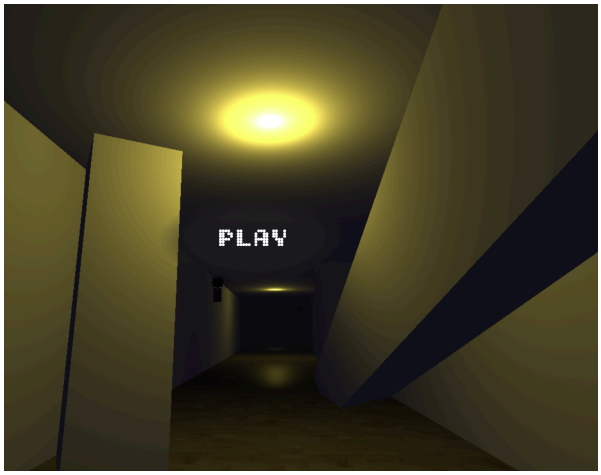
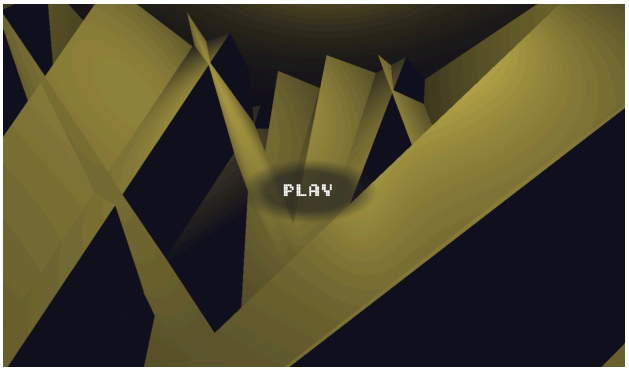
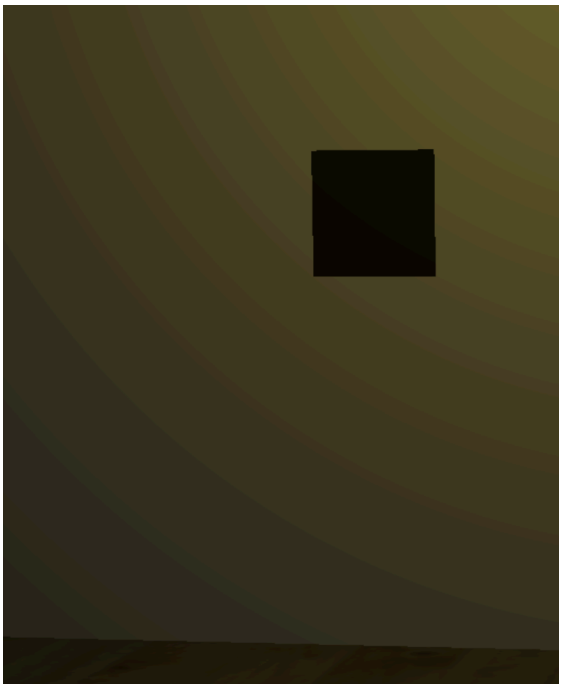
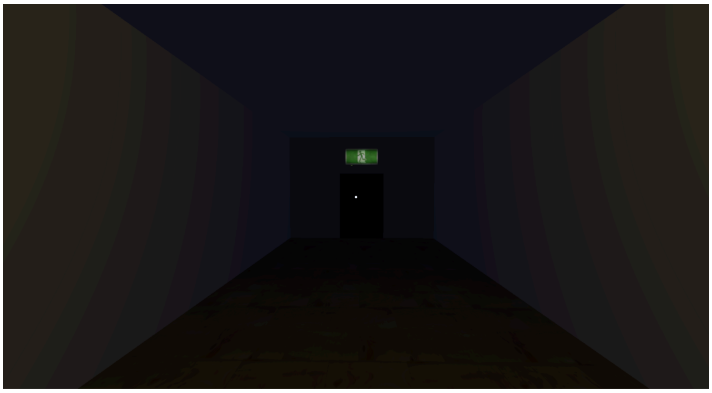
Halwaylism

The aim of this project is to make the user feel estranged and almost guilty, the main idea being that the player is searching for buttons to get deeper and deeper into the hallway resulting in a feeling of unwelcomeness. As they progress the levels continue to get harder and harder, it cements the fact that they are unwelcome. Multitudes of cameras following their every move adds on to this as well, and the music as a final touch to complete the mood. The cameras follow the player because the lookat function built into THREE.js. This makes the cameras face the user at all times to give the illusion that they are active and tracking them.

Game mechanics like sprinting and randomized button location make the game more enjoyable overall/ even replayable. As for the development it consisted of a lot of manual additions like obstacles and borders, littered with more technical parts that produce the more monotone items like cameras and lighting. For example, a common technique that we used was to make a for loop iterate through an array to place many items at a time. What made the game so immersive was the first person camera controls along with the standard WASD movement keys which allow for the player to play as if they were the ones stuck in the hallway. The library that is used for the project is THREE.js, used for making the 3D aspect.

The end of the game shows an exit that looks like any other, however when you click it, you get sent right back to the beginning, followed by a message that says “You can never leave”. This is the grand reveal about the true intentions of the game. It was made to criticize and bring awareness to surveillance capitalism and how it never stops. We are constantly being tracked and it has become an unavoidable fate for all of us. Our never ending hallway represents the cycle of constant surveillance that is inescapable.

Some works that have inspired us are *Welcome to the Game II*, a horror game where the player navigates the dark web while being constantly monitored and threatened by unseen forces, and *Papers, Please*, a simulation game where the player works as an immigration officer, performing repetitive document checks under increasing pressure and strict rules. *Welcome to the Game II* influenced the use of surveillance and the constant feeling of being watched, which is reflected in the cameras that follow the player throughout the hallway. *Papers, Please* inspired the increasing difficulty and repetitive task structure, where progression becomes more stressful over time, reinforcing the idea that the system is not designed for the player to succeed. Both works contribute to the feeling of unease, pressure, and inevitability that our project aims to create.

SCREEN GRABS